

## WD hybrid drive announced

Western Digital has taken the wraps of its first hybrid drive using the 2.5-inch 5mm design. it will sport MLC NAND memory



## Samsung 840 Series SSD

Samsung has released a new series of SSD – the 840 Series. It's a notebook-ready performance-oriented SATA 6 Gbps drive

has rubber feet on its base and has a square shape. The Mobile Drive Mq looked like most of the other drives except for its slim form factor.

Transcend StoreJet 25M3 is similar in design to its previous



Western Digital My Passport 2 TB

iterations with a dark brown rubber casing protecting the drive within. It also has a one button backup option. ADATA had a nice jigsaw puzzle design on its front face with notches to

hold the USB 3.0 cable along its edges.

Seagate had two Portable drives and BackUp Plus drive. The latter was recently introduced and it allows you not only to backup your system's data but also data from your social media. It has an option to post directly from the drive itself to Facebook, Flickr and YouTube and you can backup your data – photos and videos – on these sites as well.

It also comes with the GoFlex-type adapter to change interfaces.

To imagine 2 TB in your back pocket, just a couple of years ago was unthinkable and WD has managed to put that on a portable drive. It also has some nice textured design on the front which makes the drive look much better than the drab glossy black finish on older My Passport drives. It includes the WD SmartWare utility.

## Performance

Most of the drives performed as expected. Barring the Toshiba Canvio Plus and Seagate Portable drives, most of the other drives comfortably crossed or were very close to the 100 MB/s mark on sequential write and read operations. Silicon Power Diamond D05 was quite impressive in both read and write speeds. Segate Backup Plus offered an overall best performance in this segment. Assorted write was a killer on most drives with drives such as Transcend and Seagate Portable giving scored under 40 MB/s which was quite low comparatively. Read operations gave decent speeds for all the drives. In the intra-drive tests, the Seagate Portable 1 TB drive ran painfully slow giving around 10 MB/s and forget about using it as a scratch disk.

## Verdict

In the under 1 TB category, the **Hitachi Mobile Touro Pro** was awarded the **Best Buy** as it offered the best speeds at decent cost per GB. You do have drives with lower cost per GB but they also offer lower speeds. So if speed is not really your lookout, then we would suggest you are better off with Silicon Power Stream S20 for its affordable pricing compared to the Hitachi Mobile Touro Pro.

In the 1 TB and over category the **Best Buy** was awarded to **Seagate Backup Plus** for its very good price to performance proposition. Its social media backup feature is a definite plus.

The **Editor's Pick** was awarded to the **Western Digital My Passport 2 TB** as it offers a massive capacity at decent cost per GB and also gives good performance overall.



Seagate Backup Plus 1 TB

## DESKTOP DRIVES

These drives are basically meant for home use. Due to their bulk, they're not really portable and need to be connected to a power supply to power on the 3.5-inch HDD they house within them. This time we got around five drives all over 1 TB in capacity. Considering portable drives have started sporting 2 TB models, it wouldn't make sense to have a powered 1 TB drive unless of course you are looking for speed.

One thing that demarcates powered drives from their portable counterparts is the size of drives and speeds. Most of the drives we got here had a 3.5-inch internal drive and rotational speeds from 5900 to 7200 RPM. There were two 2 TB drives (Transcend and

## Buffalo MiniStation HD-PATU3 Thunderbolt

Buffalo MiniStation HD-PATU3 Thunderbolt, as the name implies comes with a Thunderbolt port along with a USB 3.0 port. The silvery grey and white body is quite reminiscent of Apple's design colours. The drive is comparatively bulkier than other 500 GB drives in this category except for the Seagate Satellite drive. The Thunderbolt port is present beside the USB 3.0 port. Thankfully, Buffalo bundles in a Thunderbolt cable which itself costs around ₹2,500 on the Apple store.



113.5 and 112.6 respectively whereas with USB 3.0 interface on our rig, we had got 112.4 and 111.6 respectively. The Thunderbolt interface is severely limited by the spinning hard disk drive.

So what exactly is the purpose of the Thunderbolt interface? Well, for iMac users who do not have a USB 3.0 interface but have a Thunderbolt interface it makes sense to get this drive. Although, for Windows users this drive does not make much sense.

Apart from testing the drive on our standard rig, we also connected the Thunderbolt interface to the iMac 2012 edition, which has a Thunderbolt port. The Thunderbolt interface is bottlenecked by the spinning drive and we noticed only a minor improvement in scores over the USB 3.0 drive. While running Crystal Disk Mark 3.0.1 with the Thunderbolt interface, we got Sequential Read / Write speeds of



Transcend StoreJet 35T3